

7 Wonders Duel rules summary

Object: Play cards to develop your city with Buildings and Wonders. Military victories can tax the opponent's coffers and scientific progress can provide bonuses. At the end of Age III, total your Victory Points (VPs) from Buildings, military, science, and Wonders. The player with the most VPs wins.

Setup:

1. Place the board between the players to one side with the Conflict pawn in the center of its track and the four military tokens face up on their spots.
2. Shuffle the 10 circular, green Progress tokens face down and place five face up on their spots on the board. Return the rest to the game box.
3. Give each player seven coins.
4. Randomly determine the first player.
5. Shuffle the 12 Wonder cards and place four face up between the players.
6. The first player chooses one card, then the second player chooses two, and the first player takes the remaining card.
7. Place four more cards face up between the players.
8. The second player chooses one card, then the first player chooses two, and the second player takes the remaining card.
9. Shuffle each of the three Age decks separately.
10. Randomly return three cards from each Age deck to the game box, unseen.
11. Shuffle the seven Guild cards, draw three (face down), and shuffle them into the Age III deck. Return the remaining Guild cards to the game box, unseen.

Preparing Each Age: Lay out the 20 cards for the Age according to the card structure on the back of the rulebook.

Game Turns: The first player begins Age I.

On your turn, choose an “accessible” card (one not partially covered by other cards) and play it in one of the following three options.

After playing your card, reveal any cards in the layout that were previously hidden and are now accessible.

Option 1 – Construct the Building: Pay the cost of the Building and place it into your city (play area in front of you), overlapping cards of the same color so that only the top of the card's information is visible.

Resolve the card's effect (if any) on the top. See the Helpsheet or the rulebook for the iconography.

The cost is on the left side. A card with no cost can be constructed for free.

Resource icons in the cost must either be present in your city's Buildings and constructed Wonders or must be purchased by trading.

Trading – the cost in coins for each resource icon that you need to construct a Building or Wonder is **two plus the number of symbols of the same resource produced by the brown and grey cards of the opposing city.**

Some yellow buildings set the cost of some resources to exactly one coin each.

The cost is paid to the bank.

Chains – a card in your city with a white chain symbol in the upper right means that you can construct the card with the matching white symbol under its resource cost for free.

Military – red cards and some Wonders direct you to move the Conflict pawn a number of spaces toward your opponent based on the number of sword and shield symbols on the card. When the pawn enters a zone with a military token, your opponent loses that number of coins and the token is returned to the game box.

Science and Progress – there are seven different scientific symbols in the game. Each time you gain a pair of identical symbols, take one of the Progress tokens from the board, place it in your city, and apply its effects.

Option 2 – Discard the Card to Obtain Coins: Place the card face down next to the board.

The discard pile can be viewed by the players at any time.

Gain two coins plus one coin per yellow card in your city.

Option 3 – Construct a Wonder: Pay the cost of the Wonder (on the left side) and place the Age card face down partially under the right side of the Wonder card.

Resolve the Wonder's effect on the right side.

Some Wonders allow you to take another turn when constructed.

When the seventh Wonder is constructed, return the eighth unconstructed one to the game box.

End of an Age: An Age ends once all 20 cards in the structure have been played. Prepare the next Age's structure.

If a replay effect would allow you take another turn at the end of an Age (when the card structure is empty), the effect is lost.

The player with the weakest military (i.e., the Conflict pawn is on their side of the board) chooses which player begins the next Age. If the pawn is in the middle of the board, the player that played the last card of the previous Age chooses.

Instant Victory:

Military Supremacy – if you move the Conflict pawn to the final space on its track (your opponent's capital), you immediately win the game.

Scientific Supremacy – if you gather six different scientific symbols, you immediately win the game.

Game End: If the game doesn't end in an instant victory, it ends after Age III.

Each player totals their VPs:

- VPs to one player if the Conflict pawn is on their opponent's side of the track.
- VPs from Buildings, Wonders, and Progress tokens (in the green laurels).
- 1 VP for every three coins.

If tied, the player with the most VPs from blue cards wins. Otherwise it is a shared win.